

University of Pennsylvania writing supplement

Academics

Primary School/Program to Which You Are Applying	School of Engineering & Applied Science
Primary Major of Interest	Electrical Engineering

University of Pennsylvania Wri

School Question

Incessant zapping streams across my veins as I imagine myself at Penn Engineering, the frontline of the electric revolution. I believe that the path of electrical engineering will enable me to trailblaze a future of renewable and eco-friendly energy in Kenya.

I cherish the interdisciplinary research experience at Penn, particularly in Professor Eric Stach's lab where I yearn to apply the machine learning knowledge I have accrued during my gap year towards developing techniques to optimize the structure and materials that constitute solar cells. This will bring me a step closer to my ultimate dream of powering a million needy households in Kenya using cheap solar energy.

At the Penn Electric Racing team, I hope to contribute to the development of the REV7 model for the Formula SAE EV event. Through this experiential learning, I will gain insights on how to accelerate the transition to electric vehicles and a cleaner future for my country.

I can also see myself at PennApps developing an intelligent traffic system application to alleviate the traffic congestion mayhem in Nairobi city. In an environment that values creativity, innovation, and curiosity, I'm certain that Penn Engineering is the place for me.

Community Question

I found love at first sight. It all began with a simple push of a pawn that culminated in an anticlimactic checkmate marking the beginning of my inseparable bond with the chess board. Best believe I will spend all my Wednesday nights at the lower eating area in Houston Hall, eagerly waiting to catch fellow chess club members off guard with the Van Geet opening that I've been studying all summer.

I intend to join the Penn African Students Association so as to share my Luo culture with the Penn community. I can't wait to lead the Kenyan community in traditional dances during the ASA Gala at the Bodek lounge(I've been soloing folk dances since primary school)and to share sumptuous dishes of ugali and tilapia(the unbeaten combo) across campus.

I envision myself engaging in midnight conversations along Locust Walk with my friends after our late study sessions at the Van Pelt library. I also can't wait to finally chant Penn's fight song at the Franklin field during the Penn-Princeton football game after months of practicing in the bathroom. Whether it is through Spring Fling or toast throwing, I want to be a Quaker. Go Quakers!

Gratitude Question

Dear Uncle Brian,

Remember the time you locked me in a room with Bruce, your brown labrador puppy, back when I was five and wouldn't let me out until I stroked his coat?

Though you said he wouldn't even hurt a fly, I felt like I was looking death in the eye. The room shrunk exponentially as he steadily approached me. I began sweating profusely, shaking relentlessly and crying hysterically as I sought closure with the fact that I was about to be swallowed whole by "man's best friend".

As I sit here today, alive and well, reminiscing about the indestructible bond Bruce and I formed, I'd like to thank you for showing me that fear is just an illusion. I have learned that though not all dreadful circumstances come as harmless puppies, they are often quite similar in spirit. I now see your wisdom in sharing with me Seneca's quote "We suffer more in our imagination than in reality".

Even though at the time I didn't understand what any of this meant, and kinda hated you for your savagery, you irreversibly baked fearlessness into my DNA. For that I am eternally grateful.

Regards,

Claren, your favorite nephew ;)